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Tinturaria Sarandi turns spent wattle bark into Casca Viva, a natural-dye service for small fashion labels

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From 5 October 2026 the Porto Alegre dye works will take orders for six brown, grey and graphite shades dyed with tannin-rich black-wattle bark that a tannin extraction plant in Montenegro used to burn as boiler fuel.

What is being launched

Tinturaria Sarandi Ltda., a commission dye house founded in 1961, today announced Casca Viva, a line of piece-dyed shades obtained from the spent bark of the black wattle tree (acácia-negra). After partial tannin extraction for the leather industry, the residue still gives fast, warm colours on cotton, linen and wool with an alum or iron mordant.

Casca Viva is aimed at independent labels and ateliers that cannot meet the 1,000 kg minimum of the company's conventional reactive-dye service. The pilot lot minimum is 25 kg of fabric per shade. The preview shown at a Porto Alegre design fair in June 2026 quoted a 50 kg minimum; that figure has been withdrawn. First production batches are scheduled for 19 October 2026.

"For sixty years we have dyed with synthetic colour and treated the effluent afterwards. Casca Viva starts from a residue that already exists sixty kilometres up the road and needs no salt at all," said managing director Rosângela Wiederkehr, granddaughter of the founders Heinrich and Olga Wiederkehr.

Where the bark comes from

The bark is supplied under a five-year agreement signed on 2 September 2026 with Extratos Vale do Caí Ltda., a tannin extraction plant in Montenegro, about 60 km from the dye works. The agreement covers up to 1,150 tonnes of spent bark per year, dry basis. It is delivered twice a week and stored in a new 600 m² shed beside the dye house.

Table 1. Casca Viva shade card and list prices from 5 October 2026 (BRL per kg of finished fabric, before taxes)

Code	Shade	Mordant	Light fastness (1–8)	Cotton	Linen	Wool
CV-01	Areia do Guaíba (sand)	Alum, light	4	38.50	44.00	52.00
CV-02	Canela (cinnamon)	Alum	5	41.00	46.50	55.50
CV-03	Tabaco (tobacco brown)	Alum, double bath	5	44.50	49.00	58.00
CV-04	Cinza Pampa (warm grey)	Iron, light	6	42.00	47.50	56.00
CV-05	Erva-mate (olive grey)	Alum then iron	5	46.00	51.50	60.50
CV-06	Grafite (graphite)	Iron, heavy	6	48.50	54.00	63.00

How the process works

The bark is extracted at 95 °C in a new 3,000-litre autoclave and the liquor is pumped to two 250 kg low-liquor-ratio jet machines. Fabric is mordanted in the same machine, so a batch takes about five hours instead of the eight to nine of a reactive-dye cycle. Exhausted bark is pressed and burnt in the plant's own biomass boiler.

"Natural colour is never as uniform as a reactive dye, and we say so openly. Every bulk lot is measured against the approved lab dip and leaves with a printed lot card," said technical director Everton Bortolini.

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Ordering, lot sizes and lead times

Orders are placed through the Casca Viva order desk at the Sarandi plant. Each new customer first buys a sample set (one 30 × 30 cm swatch of every shade on the chosen fibre) and approves a lab dip before the bulk lot is dyed. Lot sizes are counted per shade and per fibre; two shades on the same fabric are two lots.

Table 2. Casca Viva lot bands, lead times and conditions (lead times in working days from lab-dip approval)

Lot band	Fabric per shade	Lead time	Surcharge on list price	Colour tolerance	Deposit
Pilot lot	25–79 kg	12	+18 %	ΔE 3.0	100 %
Small lot	80–249 kg	10	+8 %	ΔE 2.5	50 %
Standard lot	250–999 kg	8	none	ΔE 2.0	30 %
Contract lot	1,000 kg and over	15	−5 %	ΔE 2.0	30 %

The sample set costs BRL 95 per fibre from 1 September 2026 and is credited against the first bulk order placed within 60 days. Until 31 August 2026 the sample set cost BRL 180 and was not credited. Contract lots have a longer lead time because the bark liquor is prepared in a dedicated extraction run. Wool is dyed only from March to November, when the autoclave is not reserved for the annual maintenance shutdown.

Background facts: the dye works

Tinturaria Sarandi employs 186 people and dyes up to 14 tonnes of fabric per day, about 85 % of it cotton knit for T-shirts and school uniforms. The investment in Casca Viva totals BRL 6.4 million, of which BRL 2.1 million is a green credit line from a cooperative bank and the rest the company's own funds. The plant treats its effluent in its own biological treatment plant before discharge to the municipal sewer.

Table 3. Resource use per kg of finished fabric: conventional reactive dyeing (2025 plant average) and Casca Viva pilot batches (July 2026)

Indicator	Unit	Reactive dyeing, 2025	Casca Viva pilot, Jul 2026	Change
Water consumption	litres per kg	92	38	−59 %
Thermal energy	MJ per kg	14.5	9.8	−32 %
Electricity	kWh per kg	1.9	1.6	−16 %
Salt (sodium chloride)	grams per kg	650	0	−100 %
Effluent COD	mg O_2 per litre	1,850	940	−49 %
Effluent colour	Pt-Co units	310	120	−61 %

Note for editors. The pilot figures in Table 3 come from 14 pilot batches (2,960 kg of cotton and linen) dyed between 1 and 31 July 2026; wool was not included. Full-production figures will follow in the 2027 environmental report.

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